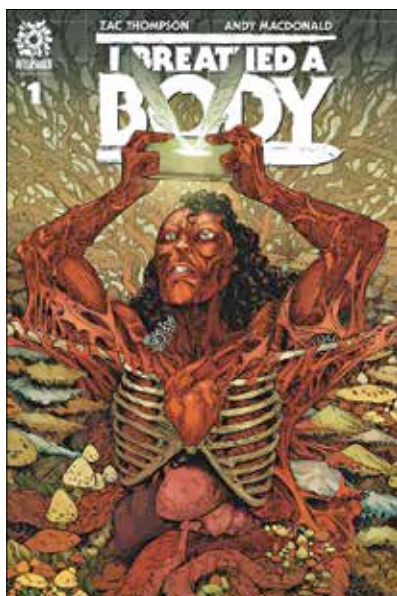


COMIC

I Breathed a Body

★★★★☆ The big tech companies that feed on the vitriolic environment they create on their social networks, the over the top content in the attention economy, and the obtuse algorithms that make people behave more like automatons and humans are the background for this supernatural horror story set in the digital age. The series is set in Silicon Valley, and right off the bat we are thrown into the offices of a fancy big tech company where a social media manager makes the call of putting a horrible clip out there, in an effort to grab more eyeballs. The spiral into disinformation, the increasing irrelevance of facts, and the cynicism with which cogs in a brutal, heartless machine is captured so realistically that you really have to look for the vague hints that this is a futuristic supernatural horror story at all.



The series does manage to capture the eeriness in the colours used, a drab and muted palette that is still functional and modern. It is only midway through the issue that you realise, oh wait a minute, this techno futuristic horror story is actually cyberpunk! Once that switch is turned on, it stays there, but it takes you a while to understand the environ-

ment the story takes place in, because the technology is pervasive, but not over the top and distracting that there is always too many cluttered elements, blinking lights, gadgets and gizmos on the panel screaming for your attention. The comics ask some deep questions such as if nothing is famous for more than a few minutes, does anything really matter anymore? Are we all caught up in a big web of manipulation, stuck without a way out? How much of the information age problems are humans suffering from deliberately? This is such a visceral and cerebral exploration into the the world created by social media platforms, algorithms, and companies that leech the whole world around them, that the supernatural part of the comics is understandable and in fact, less horrible in comparison. I Breathed a Body is telling a story that needs to be told, at just the right time. This is not a warning, it is exploring the right issues and asking relevant questions. At the same time it is a fun cyberpunk ride with striking visuals and plenty of violence. We cannot find anything wrong with this one, and cannot wait to see where it goes in the future.

ANIME

The Daily Life of the Immortal King

★★★★☆ | The Daily Life of the Immortal King is a Chinese anime, we're seeing more and more of those coming out, and there have been some really good ones. We personally really enjoyed The King's Avatar. Going into this show after having watched something like the King's Avatar is a bit of a letdown. Don't get us wrong, overall, The Daily Life of the Immortal King is a fun show, it's got great animation, the concepts are pretty cool, and there are some interesting characters as well. However, the show seems to having a bit of an identity crisis. It can't decide whether it's a parody, or



whether it should take itself seriously. For the most part, the show follows the "OP main character surrounded by people who have no idea" trope. The MC just really wants to have an ordinary life,

and he's doing his best to suppress his incredible powers. Somehow though, he ends up in the thick of things and has to do damage-control. 90 percent of the time his solution is a memory wipe. There's plenty of pop-culture references thrown in for comedic effect as well, from popular memes (salt bae for example) to other famous anime (DBZ, etc). It's all well executed and fairly funny. Clearly indicative of a parody. But then they attempt to do some very serious character-growth out of the blue, all so they could conclude in a fancy and "emotional" way. Ultimately you end up with a rather anticlimactic ending. Still, while we certainly weren't glued to our seats for the whole thing, we enjoyed watching it through to the end. There are probably other, better anime that follow the exact same trope which are executed better. If you're looking for your first Chinese anime to watch though, we recommend The King's Avatar (Quanzhi Gaoshou) instead.